



Strategic Growth Through AI

Sosland Publishing Company

Leveraging Generative AI for Operational Excellence & EBITDA Expansion at a Century-Old B2B Media Leader

PREPARED BY CHIEF AI OFFICER

CONFIDENTIAL

Company at a Glance

Sosland Publishing is the dominant B2B trade publisher serving the grain milling, baking, meat, pet food, and dairy processing industries — the only media company covering the full food value chain from commodity markets to retail shelf. Third- and fourth-generation family-owned, with record event attendance, double-digit digital revenue growth, and three new publication launches since 2018.

\$25M

Revenue

Midpoint estimate · Privately held

115

Employees

Kansas City, MO headquarters

103

Years Operating

Founded 1922

9

Publications

Grain-to-shelf food chain coverage

470K+

Registered Readers

Across 13 brands and events

The Opportunity

First-Mover Advantage

No niche food/ag trade publisher has deployed meaningful AI capabilities. Sosland's 103 years of proprietary content, commodity data, and audience intelligence represent untapped fuel for AI-powered products that competitors have not yet built.

Revenue Model Transformation

B2B publishers that convert editorial content into AI-powered data and analytics products command **30–40% EBITDA margins** versus 10–20% for traditional ad-supported models. Sosland's commodity data — MarketFocus, Sweetener Report, Purchasing Seminar — is a natural foundation.

Editorial Productivity Gap

A ~115-person team producing content across 9 titles, daily newsletters, events, and digital properties is stretched thin. AI-augmented editorial workflows can unlock **30–40% more content output** without adding headcount — enabling expansion into adjacent verticals.



Why Act Now



Margin Pressure

B2B trade magazine revenue declining at **-2.6% CAGR** · Print advertising falling **-13.5% CAGR** through 2029 · Traditional ad-supported models under structural pressure



AI Arms Race in B2B Media

RELX spending **\$1.9B/year** on technology with 17 generative AI products · Informa securing **\$75M+** in AI data licensing · Farm Journal building 4.3M-profile behavioral data engine · The gap between AI leaders and laggards is widening rapidly



Audience Expectations Shifting

71% of B2B marketers now use generative AI weekly · Advertisers demanding AI-driven audience targeting · Digital subscription revenue growing **27% industry-wide** · Static newsletters losing share to personalized, data-driven content



Consolidation Threat

PE-backed consolidators acquiring niche publishers at **4–8x EBITDA** · Urner Barry/Mintec merger creating SaaS commodity pricing competitor · William Reed's FoodNavigator draws **5M monthly users** vs. Sosland's ~160K

AI Applications Across SG&A Functions

Seven high-impact areas where generative AI delivers measurable operational savings and new revenue across Sosland's business.



Finance & Accounting

Automated ad revenue reconciliation, subscription billing intelligence, financial close acceleration, cash flow forecasting across 9 publication P&Ls

\$250K–\$375K savings · 25–35% labor reduction



Sales & Marketing

AI-powered media kit generation, programmatic ad proposal automation, advertiser lead scoring, audience intent analytics for sales team

\$625K–\$875K savings · 30–40% efficiency gain



Customer Service

AI chatbot for subscriber inquiries, automated subscription renewal management, self-service advertiser portal, 24/7 event registration support

\$150K–\$225K savings · 50–60% inquiry deflection



HR & Talent

AI recruiting assistant, onboarding automation for editorial hires, retention analytics, compliance training automation

\$125K–\$175K savings · 30–40% faster hiring



Legal & Compliance

Contract review for advertising agreements, copyright monitoring across 9 titles, automated NDA processing, regulatory content flagging

\$75K–\$125K savings · 25–35% labor reduction



Editorial & Content Ops

AI-assisted article drafting, automated content repurposing (print → digital → newsletter → social), commodity data summarization, translation for 163-country audience

\$750K–\$1.1M value · 30–40% productivity gain



Data & Analytics Products

AI-powered commodity price intelligence platform, audience behavioral segmentation for advertisers, predictive content recommendation engine, searchable AI database from directory assets

\$500K–\$850K new revenue · New revenue stream

Consolidated Financial Impact

Total projected AI-driven value across all functions over a 36-month transformation horizon.

Function	Annual Value Range	Timeline
Finance & Accounting	\$250K – \$375K	6–12 months
Sales & Marketing	\$625K – \$875K	6–12 months
Customer Service	\$150K – \$225K	6–9 months
HR & Talent	\$125K – \$175K	9–12 months
Legal & Compliance	\$75K – \$125K	9–15 months
Editorial & Content Ops	\$750K – \$1.1M	6–18 months
Data & Analytics (Revenue)	\$500K – \$850K	12–36 months
TOTAL IMPACT	\$2.48M – \$3.73M	36 months

\$350K–...

Investment Required

Over 36 months

4–7 mo

Payback Period

Rapid return on investment

608–710%

3-Year ROI

Exceptional capital efficiency

Three-Phase Transformation Roadmap

1	Phase 1 · Days 1–90 · Fast Wins Executive AI immersion workshop · Editorial content repurposing AI (print-to-digital automation) · Subscriber service chatbot · Ad sales proposal automation · AI governance framework and editorial AI use policy Investment: \$45K–\$75K Value: \$85K–\$140K run-rate
2	Phase 2 · Months 4–12 · Scale & Integrate Enterprise AI content platform across all 9 titles · AI-powered audience segmentation for advertisers · Commodity data summarization engine (MarketFocus AI) · Automated newsletter personalization · Sales enablement AI for media sales team Investment: \$150K–\$225K Value: \$1.2M–\$1.9M run-rate
3	Phase 3 · Months 13–36 · Optimize & Lead AI Center of Excellence · Commodity price intelligence SaaS product · AI-searchable directory/redbook database · Predictive content analytics · Full editorial AI integration across all titles · AI-powered event matchmaking Investment: \$155K–\$225K Value: \$2.48M–\$3.73M run-rate

Risk Management

Editorial Integrity Risk · HIGH

AI-generated content must meet 103 years of editorial standards. **Mitigation:** Human-in-the-loop mandatory for all published content · AI as drafting aid only · Editor final approval on every piece · Clear AI disclosure policy.

Fragmented Adoption · HIGH

9 titles with distinct editorial teams risk siloed AI use. **Mitigation:** AI governance framework · Steering Committee with cross-title representation · Enterprise platform by Month 8.

Data Quality Gaps · MEDIUM-HIGH

Commodity data and subscriber records need validation before AI deployment. **Mitigation:** Data readiness audit in Phase 1 · Prioritize high-quality data use cases (ad proposals, newsletter personalization) first.

Change Resistance · MEDIUM

Veteran editorial staff may resist AI tools. **Mitigation:** "AI augments, not replaces" messaging · No layoffs commitment · Tiered training for all employees · Early editorial champions program.

Copyright & IP Exposure · HIGH

AI tools trained on or generating copyrighted content create legal risk. **Mitigation:** AI use policy covering content ownership · Vendor IP indemnification requirements · Legal review of all AI-generated outputs before publication.

Vendor Lock-In · MEDIUM

Small publisher budget limits negotiating leverage. **Mitigation:** Open APIs · Multi-vendor strategy · Data portability in contracts · Quarterly vendor reviews.

Enterprise Value Transformation

AI transformation unlocks a dramatic re-rating of Sosland's enterprise value — from a traditional publisher multiple to a premium data-business multiple.

TODAY

\$12.5M – \$35.0M

\$2.5M–\$5.0M EBITDA (est. 10–20% margin on ~\$25M revenue)

× 5.0–7.0x multiple (traditional publisher)

- Ad-supported revenue model
- Print dependency
- Standard publisher valuation
- Limited data product revenue

YEAR 3 - POST-AI

\$30.0M – \$74.0M

\$5.0M–\$8.7M EBITDA (current + \$2.48M–\$3.73M AI value)

× 6.0–8.5x multiple (AI-enabled data business premium)

- Data & analytics revenue streams
- 20–35% EBITDA margins
- Premium data-company multiple
- SaaS commodity intelligence platform

❏ **Enterprise Value Created: \$17.5M – \$39.0M on \$350K–\$525K investment.** Sosland can remain independent with top-quartile margins, attract strategic buyers (Informa, RELX, Endeavor) at premium multiples, or scale revenue to \$35M–\$40M through AI-powered data products — all without proportional headcount growth.

The Choice Is Clear

 OPTION A: STATUS QUO

The Cost of Inaction

- Margin erosion as print advertising declines -13.5% annually
- Talent attrition as competitors offer AI-enabled workflows
- Valuation stagnation at 5–7x EBITDA
- Acquisition target for PE consolidators within 3–5 years
- Commodity data moat eroded by Urner Barry/Mintec SaaS platform

 OPTION B: AI TRANSFORMATION

The Path to Leadership

- \$2.48M–\$3.73M EBITDA uplift
- 20–35% EBITDA margins
- \$17.5M–\$39.0M enterprise value created
- First-mover position in food/ag trade publishing AI
- New data product revenue streams
- 103 years of content transformed into AI-powered competitive moat

Immediate Next Steps — Week 1

1

Days 1–3

CEO convenes leadership team, secures family board endorsement, commits to 3-year investment plan

2

Week 1

Engage AI consulting partner, assign Phase 1 lead, allocate \$45K–\$75K Phase 1 budget

3

Weeks 1–2

Company-wide communication: AI as force multiplier for editorial excellence, invite employee input

4

Weeks 2–4

Select Phase 1 pilots (content repurposing AI + subscriber chatbot), begin Executive Immersion training

"Sosland has spent 103 years building the most authoritative voice in food industry media. AI doesn't replace that authority — it amplifies it to reach every corner of the market."